

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 3

PRATIHARA DYNASTY

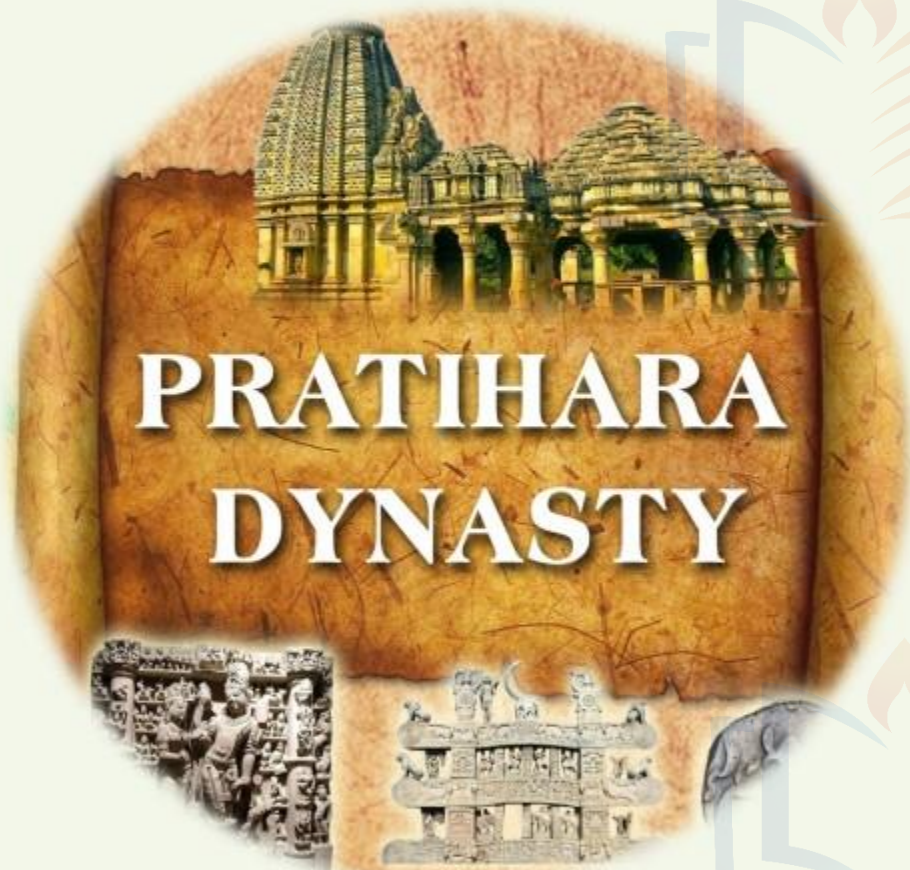




PRATIHARA DYNASTY



INTRODUCTION



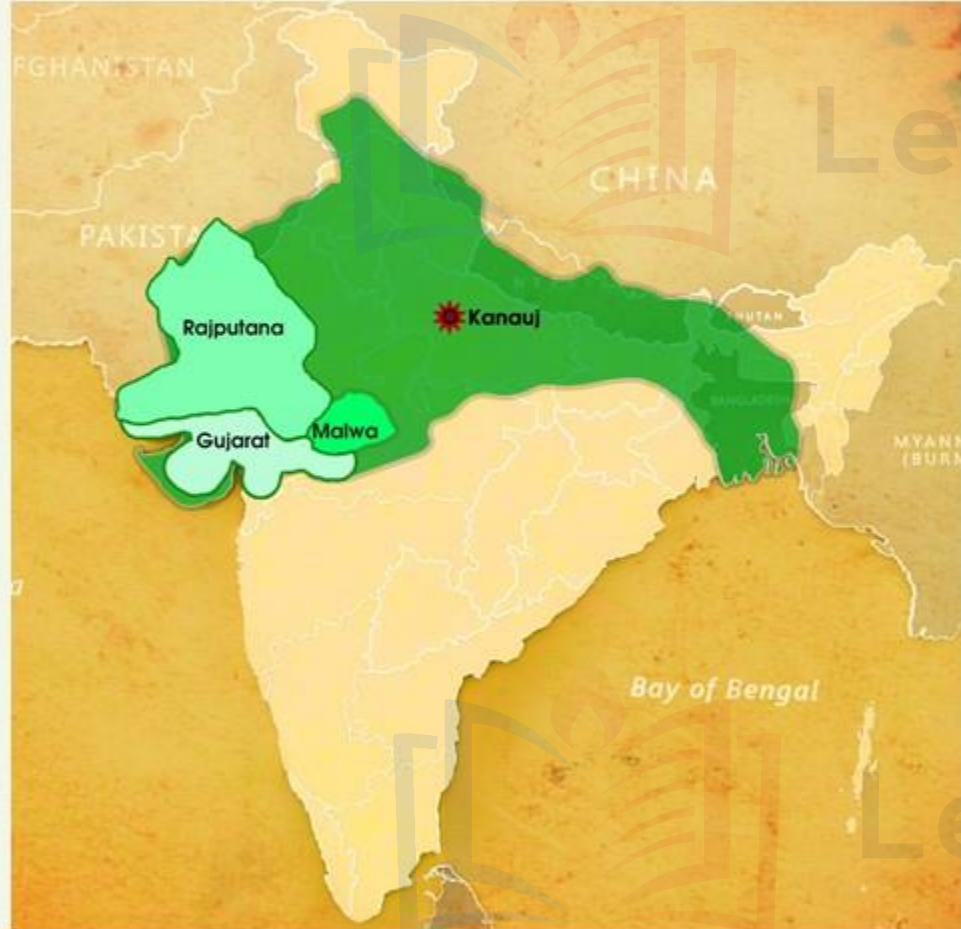
- 1 Aka GURJARA - PRATIHARA
- 2 Pratihara means "DOOR KEEPER".
- 3 Pratiharas originated from Gurjaras, who were primarily pastoralists and fighters.
- 4 Dynasty was founded by a Brahmana named "*Harichandra*".
- 5 Pratiharas were instrumental in containing Arab armies in the North West Part.
- 6 Dynasty attained prominence in 8th Century mainly during the reign of **NAGABHATTA I**

GURJARA PRATIHARA EMPIRE



PRATHARA DYNASTY

NAGABHATTA - I (730-760 CE)



- 1 He was known for checking the invasions of the Arabs and offered most successful resistance. Defeated Arab attack led by *JUNAID & TAMIM*
- 2 He exercised control over the areas of MALWA, RAJPUTANA, GUJARAT
- 3 He was defeated by the Rastrakuta King *Dhruva*
- 4 His capital was **AVANTI** in Malwa.

NAGABHATTA - I
[730 AD - 760 AD]

VATSARAJA
[780 AD - 800 AD]

NAGABHATTA - II
[800 AD - 833 AD]

MIHIR BHOJA (BHOJA-I)
[836AD - 885 AD]

MAHENDRAPALA
[885AD - 910AD]

MAHIPALA
[913AD - 944AD]

RAJYAPALA
[960AD - 1018AD]

YASHPALA
[1024AD - 1036AD]

PRATIHARA DYNASTY

VATSARAJA (780-800 CE)

1 He extended the rule of Nagabhatta I to large parts of North India.

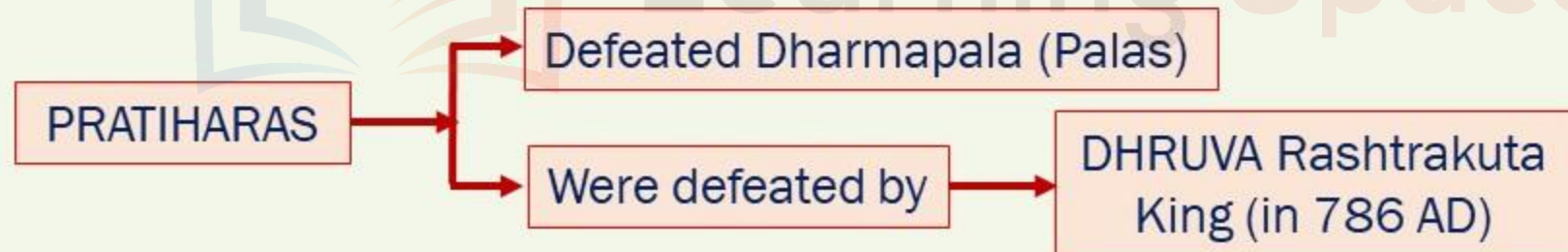
2 Made **KANNAUJ** in western UP his capital.

3 BEGINNING OF TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

4 Vatsaraja policy of expansion brought him in conflict with:

- **DHARAMAPALA**, the Pala king of Bengal
- **DHRUVA**, Rashtrakuta King

5 This struggle over Kannuj continued for another 350 years.



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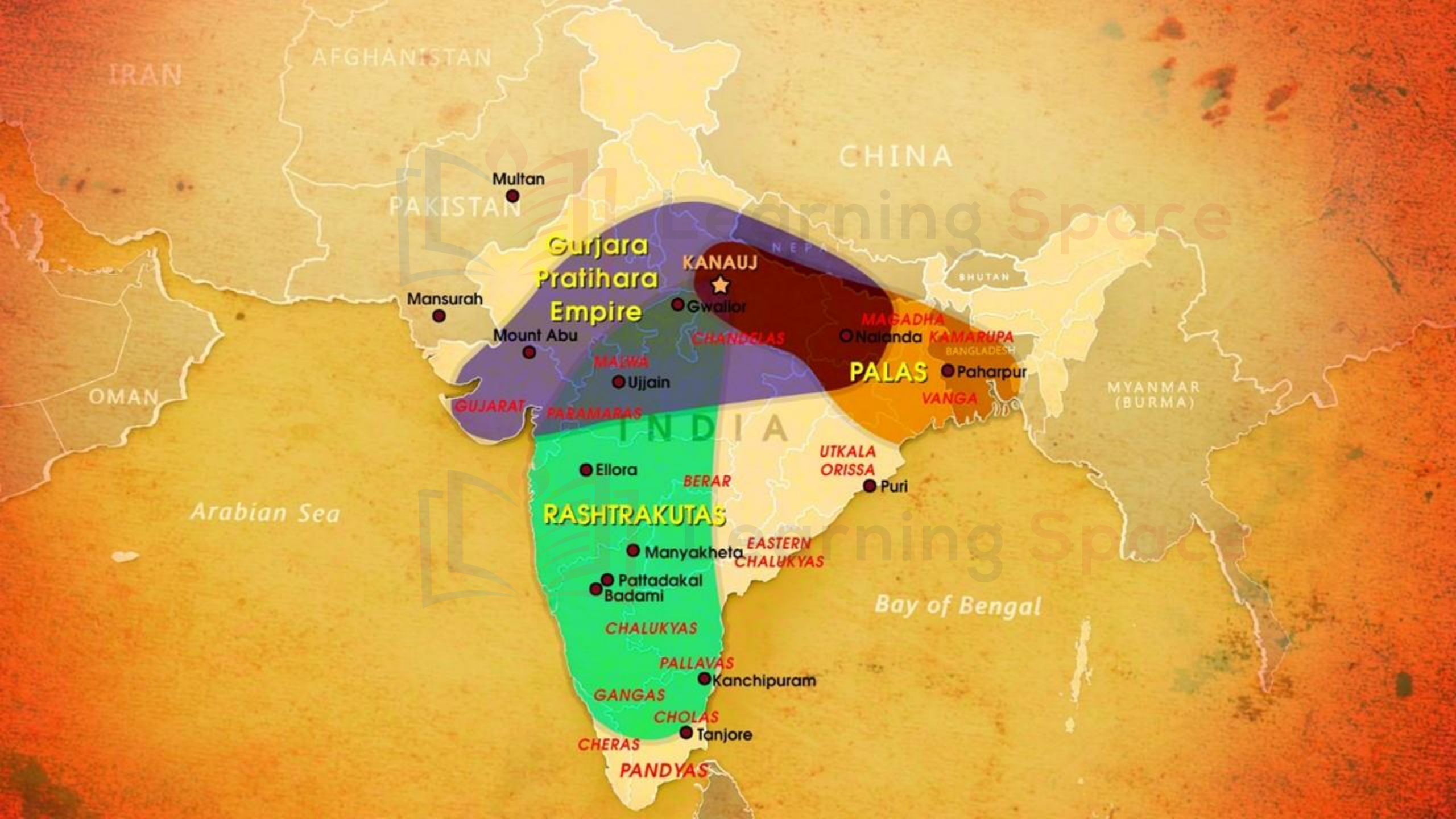
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IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

Multan

Gurjara
Pratihara
Empire

KANAUJ

Gwalior

Mansurah

Mount Abu

MAIWA

Ujjain

MAGADHA

Nalanda

KAMARUPA

BANGLADESH

PALAS

Paharpur

VANGA

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

OMAN

GUJARAT

PARAMARAS

INDIA

UTKALA
ORISSA

Puri

Ellora

BERAR

RASHTRAKUTAS

Manyakheta

Pattadakal

Badami

EASTERN
CHALUKYAS

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

Kanchipuram

GANGAS

CHOLAS

Tanjore

CHERAS

PANDYAS

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

PRATIHARA DYNASTY

NAGABHATTA - II (800-833 CE)



Nagabhatta II is hailed for rebuilding the SOMNATH TEMPLE.

- 1 During his reign Pratiharas became the most powerful dynasty of North India
- 2 During his reign too, tripartite struggle continued

PRATI HARAS
(Nagabhatta - II)

Again defeated Dharmapala (Palas)

Again defeated by GOVIND III (Rashtrakuta)

(Nagabhatta - II)

Succeeded by his son RAMABHADRA
(Ruled briefly)

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PAKISTAN

RAJASTHAN

ARABIAN SEA

GUJARAT

MADHYA PRADESH



Somnath Temple

MAHARASHTRA

PRATHARA DYNASTY

MIHIRA BHOJA (BHOJA - I) (836-885 CE)



MIHIRA BHOJA

Grandson of
Nagabhatta - II

Had a long
reign of over 46
years

Was recorded
as the most
popular &
successful ruler
of Pratiharas

1 During his *early years* of his reign, he was defeated by the Palas, Rashtrakutas and Kalachuris.

2 But subsequently he made a comeback and with the aid of feudatories such as *Chedis* and *Guhilas*, he won victories over the Palas and Rashtrakutas.

3 He had his capital at *Kannauj*, which was also called MAHODAYA.

4 Was a devotee of *Lord Vishnu* and adopted the title of '*Adivaraha*'.

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PRATIHARA DYNASTY

TRAVELER'S ACCOUNT

SULAIMAN

ARAB MERCHANT OF THE 9th CENTURY

- Identified Bhoja I as *KING JUZR*
- Praises his great military power and riches
- Praises his administration for keeping the empire safe from robbers.

AL-MASUDI

ARAB TRAVELER

- Called Bhoja - I as *King Baura*
- Marked Cavalry of Pratiharas to be the best in India



His Supremacy was
acknowledged by

The Kalachuris

The Chandalas

Arabs of Sindh



PRATIHARA DYNASTY

MAHENDRAPALA (885-910 CE)



1

Under Mahendrapala, Pratihara empire reached to the:

- WEST to the border of Sindh
- EAST to BENGAL
- NORTH to the HIMALAYAS
- SOUTH past the river Narmada

The empire became comparable to that of Gupta Empire

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MIHIR BHOJA (BHOJA-I)
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**MAHENDRAPALA
[885AD - 910AD]**



MAHIPALA
[913AD - 944AD]



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HIMALAYA REGION

SINDH REGION

PRATIHARA

NARMADA RIVER

BENGAL REGION

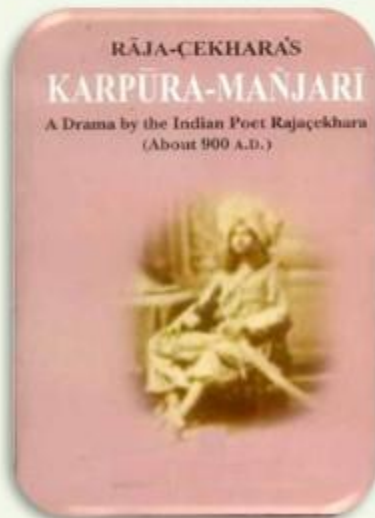
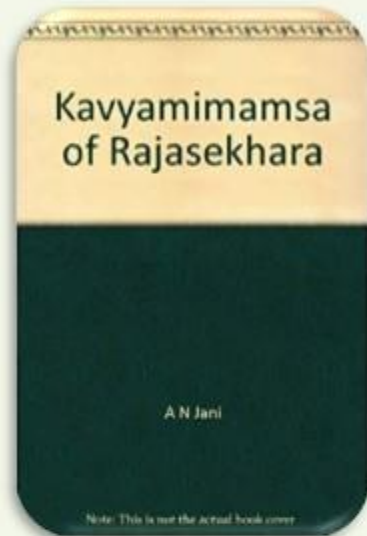
Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

Learning Space

PRATIHARA DYNASTY

MAHENDRAPALA (885-910 CE)



- 2 During his region, Pratiharas fought with the *King Of Kashmir*. Pratiharas lost the battle and had to yield him some of the territories in the Punjab won by Bhoja.
- 3
 - Mahehdrapala - I was a liberal patron of literature.
 - He took the title of **MAHARAJADHIRAJ OF ARYAVARTA** (Great King of Kings of Northern India)
 - His court was adorned by **RAJASHEKAR** who was an eminent poet in Sanskrit.
- 4 Some of his important works of *Rajashekar* includes:
 - ✓ KARPURA MANJARI - play
 - ✓ KAVYA MIMANSA - practical guide for poets that explains the elements and composition of a good poem.
 - ✓ VIDHASALA - BHANJIK.

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[1024AD - 1036AD]

PRATHARA DYNASTY

MAHIPALA

(913-944 CE)

- 1 Mahipala faced defeat from the *Rashtrakuta King Indra III*, who completely devastated the city of KANNAUJ.
- 2 Gujrat passed into the hands of the Rashtrakuta in this period.

RAJYAPALA

(960-1018 CE)

- 1 Rashtrakuta King **Krishna III** invaded North India in 963CE and defeated the Pratihara rulers.
- 2 During Rajyapala reign, raid of Mahmud Ghazni happened on Kannauj. Rajyapala had fled from the battlefield.



Mahmud
Ghazni

YASHPALA

(1024-1036 CE)

- 1 Last ruler of the Pratihara Dynasty.
- 2 By 1090 CE, the Gadhavalas conquered Kannauj.

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[730 AD-760 AD]

VATSARAJA
[780 AD-800 AD]

NAGABHATTA - II
[800 AD-833 AD]

MIHIR BHOJA (BHOJA-I)
[836AD-885 AD]

MAHENDRAPALA
[885AD-910AD]

MAHIPALA
[913AD - 944AD]

RAJYAPALA
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END OF PRATHARAS



- 1 Successive reigns of incapable rulers in Pratiharas saw rising influence of the feudatories.
- 2 They had started asserting their will for independence and eventually with the raid of Ghaznavids, Pratiharas were wiped off .
- 3 Eventually, we saw the rise of
 - **CHAUHANS** in Rajputana
 - **CHALUKYAS** in Gujarat
 - **PARAMARAS** in Malwas



IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

Rajputana

Kanauj

NEPAL

INDIA

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

OMAN

Gujarat

Malwa

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

PRATIHARA DYNASTY

POINTS TO REMEMBER



- 1** In Pratihara rule, several **Samants** were appointed by the King. These samants would give military help to the king when called upon.

- 2** **No evidence of *Mantriparishad*:** While evidence suggesting 'advice being taken by the king from high ranking officers' is found, no reference of "council of ministers" is found in the inscription.

- 3** **Decentralization**
Sub division of state into **Bhukti**, **Mandalas** and **Villages** was done. Villages in Pratihara kingdom were locally administered.

POINTS TO REMEMBER



4

ECONOMY

- Mainly of Agrarian nature
- Tax levied on agricultural production – was major source of revenue for government
- Copper coins - major and most prevalent form of medium of exchange during that period.

POINTS TO REMEMBER



5 TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE

- Pratiharas were known for their temple art.
- TELI KA MANDIR at Gwalior fort.

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SINCERE THANKS
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